

What we are building

☐ the application acting on its own ☐ a person using it

THE FOUNDATION

01 Team of specialist assistants

Not one assistant doing everything — several specialists, each responsible for one area, with a coordinator dividing the work between them.

◆ You ask "*who can build a course on spreadsheet automation?*" One specialist checks who knows the subject, another checks who is free, a third checks workload — and you get a single answer.

02 One connected record

Everything in one place — people, courses, rooms, equipment, documents — instead of separate files that cannot see each other.

"Which courses has Priya written, and what is she building now?" Answered in one go, because the records are linked to each other.

03 Three ways to do everything

Every task can be done by filling a form, typing a message, or speaking. All three do exactly the same thing.

Booking a room by tapping the calendar, by typing "*book the hall Tuesday at 2*", or by saying it aloud — the same booking, the same approval, the same record.

04 Roles and permissions

Controls what each person can see and do — by their role, by which records concern them, and down to individual fields.

A course writer opens an employee record and sees the role and contact details, but not the pay. The assistant will not reveal it either.

Detail in the appendix, section C

05 Complete activity record

A permanent record of every action — who did it, when, and how to undo it — including anything the application did by itself.

◆ "*Who changed this course's due date?*" It shows the person, the date and time, and offers to put it back.

06 Figures you can question

Any number shown anywhere can be opened up to see exactly how it was worked out.

The team summary says a course is 60% done. Tap it and see which modules are finished, which are not, and when each moved.

07 Personal assistant

Your own assistant, not one shared company one. It answers from where you stand — your work, your team, what you are permitted to see — remembers your earlier conversations, and follows you between phone and computer. It also points out problems with your own workload before they bite.

"What's on me today?" — your deadlines, your approvals, what you are waiting on from others. Nothing belonging to anyone else.

◆ "You have committed eight hours of work to a day that already has three hours of meetings."

Detail in the appendix, section D

HOW IT ACTS ON ITS OWN

08 Standing instructions

Describe a rule once in ordinary words, and it is followed from then on without being asked again.

◆ You say once: "if a course sits in review more than five days, tell me." Every course is then checked every day, indefinitely.

09 Earning the right to act alone

Anything new starts by asking permission, and only acts by itself after repeatedly getting it right. Anything involving money or people always asks.

◆ "I have drafted this reminder ten times and you approved every one unchanged. Shall I send them myself from now on?"

Detail in the appendix, section B

10 Suggestions from watching

It notices routines people repeat by hand and offers to take them over. Nothing is automated unless you agree.

◆ "Every Monday you check which courses are overdue. Would you like me to send that list at 9am instead?"

11 Asking at the right moment

Rather than hoping people fill in forms, it asks one short question at the moment the answer exists — and never asks more than twice a day.

◆ End of day: "Was the air conditioning on today?" — "Yes, 9 to 6." Recorded in four seconds, with no form to find.

EVERYDAY USE

12 Speaking to it

Speak instead of typing, on computer or phone. It confirms before saving anything, and never reads private information aloud in a shared room.

Walking out of a room: *"the projector in Hall 2 isn't working."* It repeats it back to confirm, then logs the fault against that room.

13 Daily briefing

A short summary for each person — what changed, what needs them today, and what is at risk. This is where most of what it notices is delivered.

♦ *"The AI for Presentations course is a day behind. Priya's leave needs your approval. Six people have not acknowledged the new policy."*

14 Daily commitments

Turns the briefing into a plan. Each morning the assistant takes you through your brief as a conversation, then asks what you are doing today and how long each will take. The day appears on your dashboard, where you can reorder it and tick things off. If something runs over, the application asks why — but only when it does not already know.

♦ *"Which of these are you doing today?"* You tap three and tap a time for each — no typing. They appear on your dashboard around your meetings. At six o'clock: *"the module took longer than the two hours you planned — what happened?"*

Detail in the appendix, section A

15 Technology and AI news

A panel on the home screen with current AI and technology news, filtered to the subjects you teach. The same for everyone.

♦ *"A major update to a tool you teach was released this week. Your course covering it was last revised eight months ago."*

THE EMPLOYEE SIDE

16 Employee records and directory

Staff records, documents, reporting lines and a searchable directory. Sensitive fields are restricted.

♦ *"Three people have no signed contract on file. Shall I chase them?"*

17 Leave and attendance

Leave requests, entitlement balances, approvals and attendance — by form, message or voice.

"Taking Friday off." It checks nothing clashes, then sends it to the right person for approval.

18 Joining and leaving

A guided process for a new person's first weeks, and for a departing person's handover — with owners for each step rather than a checklist nobody opens.

♦ *"Meena left last month. Two laptops are still assigned to her, and one course still lists her as owner."*

19

Course team progress

Knows what the team is building, taken from the work itself rather than status forms or status meetings.

♦ *"How is the AI for Data Analysis course going — still on track for Friday?" — "Almost done, just the tasks left." That one line updates the whole team picture.*

20

Who is best for the work

Answers who is best suited to a piece of work and shows why — based on what people have actually produced, not what they claim.

♦ *"Arun. He wrote the related course and reviewed two others, and has the lightest load this week."*

21

Capability gaps

Compares what the team can do against what the course catalogue needs.

♦ *"Only one person can build courses on data analysis. If they leave, that subject stops."*

22

Organizational memory

Remembers what was decided and why, so knowledge is not lost when someone is away or leaves.

♦ A new joiner asks *"why do we shadow someone for two weeks before taking our own course?"* It finds the decision, the reason given at the time, and who made it — even though nobody involved is still on the team.

COURSE WORK

23 Course building pipeline

Manages a course from first outline to publication, with clear stages, owners and full version history.

♦ *"The AI for Presentations course has been waiting for review for eight days."*

24 Presentations and documents

Anyone can ask for a presentation or document on any subject and get a finished draft in the organization's own format.

"Make a deck introducing spreadsheet automation." Fourteen slides come back, correctly formatted and branded, ready to edit.

THE WORKPLACE

25 Room and hall booking

Books halls and rooms, checks the space actually suits, and sorts out clashes instead of simply refusing.

♦ You book the hall at 3pm but it is taken. *"Move the other booking to the small room?"* — and once you agree, they are told.

26 Meetings and video calls

Sets up meetings from one instruction — finds a time everyone is free, books the room if it is in person, **creates the video link if it is online**, and sends everything to everyone in one action. Meetings can be in person, online or both. Meetings appear in each attendee's day alongside their work, and any work they displace is rescheduled automatically.

"Set up a review with the course team on Tuesday afternoon, online." Time found, link created, invitations sent — one step, and nobody has to paste a link anywhere.

Day planning — [appendix A6](#) · [links and online meetings](#) — [appendix E7](#)

27 Common calendar

A shared month view of every meeting and event across the organization. Open to everyone — anyone can see it, and anyone can edit it, including adding or removing people. Whenever something changes, everybody it affects is told what changed and who changed it.

♦ *"Arun moved Thursday's review to 3pm and added Meena. You were already free."*

[Detail in the appendix, section E](#)

28 Meeting decisions carried through

Takes the notes, identifies what was decided, assigns the actions to named people, and follows them up until done.

♦ *"You agreed to review the AI Basics module by Friday — is that done?"*

29 Events

Runs an event from proposal to conclusion — tasks, budget, suppliers, speakers, registrations, materials and a closing report.

♦ *"The event is in nine days. Three tasks are overdue and registrations are behind where they were last time."*

30 Rooms and utilities used

A record of which rooms were used and how long equipment ran each day, captured by a short question rather than a register anyone has to keep.

♦ "Hall 1 — air conditioning on, 9am to 6pm, Tuesday." Recorded in seconds and available to look back over for any period.

31 Equipment register

A record of equipment, who holds it, its condition and its servicing history. Faults can be reported on the spot, including by voice.

♦ "The projector in Hall 2 has been reported faulty three times this month."

32 Document storage

Documents filed against the record they belong to — a course, an employee, an event — with version history and access by role. It knows which documents are required, not only which have been supplied.

♦ "The insurance certificate expires in thirty days."

33 Announcements and policies

Sends notices and policies to the organization, and records who has confirmed reading them.

♦ "Six of twenty-two people have not acknowledged the new policy. Send a reminder?"

Rules behind five features

Most features are fully described by a line and an example. Five have rules that do not fit there, and those rules decide whether the feature is useful or resented. They are set out here so nothing is left to interpretation when it is built.

A Daily commitments

A1 The morning conversation

The first time the application is opened each day, the brief arrives as a conversation — not a list of cards on a screen. The assistant works through the items one at a time, and the day is planned in the same conversation.

- The assistant raises each item in turn, and **waits for an answer before moving on**.
- ★ **Every question carries tappable replies inside the conversation**. The whole brief can be cleared without typing a single word. Typing and speaking remain available for anything the buttons do not cover.
- When the brief is finished it asks "*what are you doing today?*" and you choose from what came out of it, or add something else.
- **For each item you give a time estimate. This is required** — not optional.
- If you skip it, the assistant explains why it cannot: "*I need a time for each one — otherwise I cannot tell later whether it ran over or whether something else took the time.*" Nothing is committed until every item has one.
- The conversation ends and **the day appears on the dashboard**.
- ★ **This happens once a day**. Opening the application again in the afternoon goes straight to the dashboard — the brief does not return.

Why the conversation comes first, and why the buttons matter. A conversation is the honest shape for this — one assistant taking you through your morning, identical whether you read it, type to it or speak to it. **But chat-first must never mean typing-first**. Nobody types eight answers on a phone every morning; they would stop within a week. The buttons live inside the conversation so it stays a conversation while costing no more effort than tapping a list.

A1b The dashboard afterwards

- Shows the day as **current work status** — your committed work **interleaved with the meetings you already have**, in time order, so you are looking at the real day rather than an empty one. See A6.
- A **checkbox on each item**, ticked as you finish.
- **Items can be dragged into any order, at any time**. The morning plan is a starting point, not a contract — people reorder their day as it goes, and the application should follow rather than object.
- The assistant remains available from the dashboard, for anything you want to raise yourself.

A1c Where the assistant speaks during the day

There is one assistant and one voice. It appears in two places, and which one depends on how much there is to say.

In the chat

Anything with substance — the morning brief, planning the day, explaining a miss, anything you want to discuss

A small prompt on the dashboard

Single things answerable in one tap, shown where you are working. Every prompt carries an "explain in chat" option, which opens the conversation with that item already loaded

✦ The module took longer than the two hours you planned. What happened?
[Underestimated] [Blocked] [Explain in chat]

The chat never opens by itself while you are working. You tapping into it is fine; it appearing over what you are doing is not — that is the behaviour people switch off.

A2 Telling the two kinds of miss apart

When a committed item is not finished in its time, the application looks at the window that was committed and asks one question of itself: **did something else take that time?** It checks for meetings, room bookings and other commitments inside the window, and how much of it they consumed.

	INTERRUPTED	RAN OVER
What happened	Something else took the time	The work simply took longer
Does it know why?	Yes — it scheduled the meeting	No
Question asked	None	One, short
Streak	Unaffected	Breaks
Dashboard shows	"carried over — meeting"	"ran over"

The rule that matters most. Only ask when the application genuinely does not know. If it asks "why didn't you finish?" about an hour consumed by a meeting it booked itself, people will stop trusting it — and that is the fastest way to make the whole system feel like a supervisor rather than a help.

A3 When you were interrupted

- **No question is asked.**
- The remaining time is carried to your next available slot, or you reschedule it yourself.
- **Your streak is unaffected.** You did not fail; you were interrupted.
- The dashboard records it as carried over, with the cause — not as a failure.

A4 When it simply ran over

Two separate moments, and **they must not be confused.** The application speaks when the time runs out, and it speaks again when the work is finished — but it says completely different things.

	THE MOMENT IT RUNS OVER	WHEN FINISHED, OR END OF DAY
What it says	An offer — about what to do next	A question — about what happened
Why then	You are still working. Useful now	You have finished. Costs nothing to answer
Interrupts?	Yes — briefly, because it helps	No — it waits for you

The moment it runs over — an offer

✦ Module 4 is running over. Your 12:00 session will not fit. [**Move it**] [**Drop the Friday prep**] [**Leave it**]

- It is about **what to do next**, never about what went wrong.
- It appears **only if the overrun actually affects the rest of the day**. If nothing later is at risk, it says nothing at all and simply lets you carry on.
- Whatever you choose, the day **rearranges itself** — you do not replan by hand.

The distinction that decides whether people accept this feature. Asking "*why didn't you finish?*" while somebody is *still doing the work* is the fastest way to make the application feel like a supervisor. Saying "*this is overrunning and your afternoon will not fit*" at that same moment is genuinely helpful. **Same timing, opposite effect. Interrupt to help, never to interrogate.**

When you finish, or at the end of the day — the question

✦ The module took four hours against the two you planned. What happened?

- **One short question**, and only one.
- Asked when you **tick the item complete late**, or at the **end of the day** if it is still unfinished — never while you are mid-task.
- Answerable **in one tap** from the dashboard prompt, or in the chat if you want to explain properly.
- It counts against the limit of **two questions per person per day** that applies everywhere in the application.
- If you ignore it, **it lapses quietly**. No reminder, no second ask. The item is recorded as unexplained.

A5 What it does with your answer

The answer is sorted into a reason — underestimated, blocked by someone else, the work grew, or something else — and used to improve future estimates rather than to judge you.

✦ You said two hours and it took four. That is usual for review work — shall I plan for four next time?

A miss becomes better planning, not a black mark. That is the entire purpose of asking.

A6 Meetings

Meetings are handled two different ways, decided by one thing only: **was the meeting already booked when the day was planned?**

WHAT HAPPENS	
Already booked when you plan	Built into the plan from the start. You commit work around it, never as though the day were empty
Booked during the day	Simply accepted. It appears in your day, displaced work is marked interrupted , and nothing is negotiated

Meetings you already have — planning around them

When you plan the day, your meetings are already known, so they sit in the sequence alongside your work. You are planning the real day, not an imaginary empty one.

09:00 ☐ Module 4 · 2h

11:00 ☒ Review with Arun · 1h

12:00 ☐ Prepare Friday session · 1h

14:00 ☒ Team catch-up · 30m

Meetings 1h 30m · Work 4h · Free 1h 30m

- Meetings and committed work appear in **one sequence**, in time order — not two separate lists to reconcile in your head.
- The application shows what is left: **meeting time, committed work time, and time still free**.
- If the two do not fit, it says so before you commit:

◆ You have 1½ hours of meetings and have committed 6 hours of work. That is more than the day holds.

Meetings that arrive later — accepted, not negotiated

- The meeting **goes in**. The application does not warn the organiser, does not offer an alternative time, and does not ask anyone to move.
- It **appears in your day** in the right place in the sequence.
- Work it displaces is **rescheduled automatically** and marked **interrupted**.
- You are **not asked why** that work did not finish, and **your streak is unaffected** — the time was taken from you, so you are not held responsible for the consequence.
- You are simply told what changed:

◆ Arun booked a review 11–12. Module 4 moves to tomorrow. [OK]

Why it is this simple. A plan can only be clashed with once it exists, and plans are made each morning. A meeting booked for next week cannot conflict with a day nobody has planned yet — so the only real case is a meeting booked today, for today, and that is not worth negotiating over. **Accept it, show it, and make sure nobody is blamed for the time it took.**

A7 Streak

- A day counts as clean when **every committed item was finished within its time**.
- **Interrupted misses do not break it.** Ran-over misses do.
- A day with no commitments neither builds nor breaks the streak.
- **Personal only.** Not visible to the team, not compared between people, not shown to a manager.

Watch for this. Streaks tempt people to protect them by padding estimates — saying four hours for a two-hour job. The signal to look for is the gap between what someone estimates and what the application has learned they actually need. If those drift apart over time, the streak is distorting the data.

A8 Who sees what

	THE PERSON	THEIR MANAGER
What was committed	Yes	Yes
Whether it was done	Yes	Yes
Time estimates	Yes	Yes
Streak	Yes	No
Reason given for a miss	Yes	Open — see below

Still to decide. Whether a manager sees the reason someone gives for a miss. The recommendation is that they do not — a manager sees what was committed and whether it was done, while the reason stays between the person and the application. People answer honestly when nobody is reading over their shoulder, and honest answers are the only thing that makes the estimate learning in A5 work at all.

A9 Edge cases

SITUATION	WHAT HAPPENS
Planning abandoned halfway	Nothing is committed — an item without a time never becomes part of the day. Next time the application is opened it resumes where it stopped rather than starting the brief again: " <i>you were choosing what to do today — shall we finish?</i> " If it is never finished, the day is simply unplanned: not chased, no effect on the streak
Never started at all	Treated as ran over, unless something else took the window — then interrupted
Half done	Progress recorded, remainder carried forward. Only the shortfall counts against the day
Item added mid-day	Allowed. It needs a time estimate like anything else
Item dropped mid-day	Allowed. Asked once why, does not break the streak
Work spanning several days	Commit a slice per day, not the whole thing. Estimating a five-day job in one line is where this feature would otherwise fall apart
A day with no commitments	Fine. Not chased, no effect on the streak either way

The question is ignored

Lapses quietly. Recorded as unexplained, never asked again

Someone is on leave

No commitments expected, nothing asked, streak paused rather than broken

B Earning the right to act alone

- Every new automatic action **begins supervised** — it prepares the work and asks a person, every time.
- After **ten approvals in which nothing was changed**, it offers to graduate.
- **Editing the draft resets the count.** Approval only counts when the person accepted it as written — otherwise it has not actually proved anything.
- Graduation is **offered, never assumed**. A person has to agree.
- **One tap returns it to supervised**, at any time, by anyone permitted.
- **Three categories never graduate, regardless of record:** anything involving money, anything affecting a person's employment, and anything that leaves the organization.
- An automatic action runs **under the authority of whoever set it up**, capped at what that person could do by hand. If their role changes or they leave, **it suspends automatically** — no rule outlives its owner.

c Roles and permissions

Three levels, applied together. A role alone is not enough — it cannot express "*this person sees their own team, not everyone*".

LEVEL	QUESTION IT ANSWERS	EXAMPLE
Role	What kind of user is this?	Course writer, HR, finance, manager
Record	Which records concern them?	Their own team, their own courses
Field	Which parts of a record?	Can open the employee record, cannot see the pay

Worked example. A course writer opens a colleague's employee record. Their **role** permits opening employee records at all. The **record** level limits them to their own team. The **field** level hides pay and performance notes. They see a name, a role and a contact number — and the assistant, asked the same question, returns exactly the same and no more.

- **Actions are controlled separately:** viewing, creating, editing, approving, exporting and deleting.
- **Exporting is not the same as viewing.** Being able to see a list on screen and being able to download it are different rights, and conflating them is the most common mistake made in systems like this.
- **The common calendar is exempt** — no role restriction applies to it. Section E.
- The same rules apply identically whether someone uses the screens, types to the assistant, or speaks — so the assistant can never become a way around them.

One deliberate exception: the common calendar. Everything above applies across the application *except* the calendar, which is open to everyone with no role restriction at all. See section E for why, and what replaces permission as the safeguard.

D What the assistant will and will not comment on

The personal assistant does three things, and the third needs a boundary drawn around it.

LEVEL	WHAT IT MEANS	EXAMPLE
Answers	You ask, it tells you	"Who is waiting on me?"
Suggests	Offers something you did not ask for; you decide	"Want me to send that list every Monday?"
Points things out	Warns you about your own work before it bites	"You have committed eight hours to a day with three hours of meetings."

It comments on the work

- "You have committed eight hours of work to a day that already has three hours of meetings."
- "This has been on your list four days running."
- "The course is due Friday and two of its modules have not been started."
- "Arun is waiting on your review before he can continue."

All four are **facts the application can already see** — commitments, calendar, deadlines, dependencies. It is pointing out what is already true, not forming an opinion.

It does not comment on the person

- "You work more slowly in the afternoons"
- "You should take a break"
- "You are behind compared to Priya"

The line, and why it matters. The moment the assistant comments on *you* rather than *your work*, it stops being a colleague and becomes something people switch off. The third example is the worst of them — **comparing people is never done**, in any feature, anywhere in this application. Workload, deadlines and dependencies are fair game because they are observable facts about the work. Habits, pace and character are not.

E Common calendar

E1 What is on it — and what deliberately is not

ON THE CALENDAR	NOT ON THE CALENDAR
Meetings — internal and external, with their attendees Events — the ones the organization runs	Halls and rooms — booked and viewed in feature 25, where availability is checked at the moment of booking Leave Individual daily work — that is the dashboard Deadlines, expiries, holidays — the assistant raises these directly

Two things only. The temptation with a shared calendar is to keep adding layers until every cell is full and nobody can see anything. Meetings and events are what people actually need to see a month ahead.

E2 A month view, and only a month view

- **Monthly is the only view.** The dashboard already covers today hour by hour, so a day or week view would duplicate it.

- A cell shows **density, not detail** — a dot for each meeting, events named because there are few of them. A cell cannot hold four meetings written out, so it does not try.
- **Tap a day** to see that day's meetings and events in full. Tapping today opens the dashboard.
- It answers the questions only a month view can: "*can we run an event on the 18th?*", "*how many meetings are there that week?*", "*what is already booked in September?*"

E3 Open to everyone — no permission restriction

The calendar is the one deliberate exception to the permission model in section C. Everyone can see everything on it, and everyone can change everything on it.

- **Anyone can create** a meeting or event.
- **Anyone can edit** one — change the time, the date, the title, the detail.
- **Anyone can add or remove people**, including from meetings they did not create.
- **Anyone can cancel** one.
- There is **no owner privilege**, no organiser lock, and no role that can do more than another.

What replaces permission as the safeguard. Open editing is only safe if nothing can happen quietly. Three things carry that weight, and **all three are required — dropping any one of them makes the open calendar unsafe:**

1 · Everyone affected is told. Any change notifies every person in that meeting or event — what changed, and who changed it.

2 · Every change is recorded. Feature 05 applies in full: who, when, what it was before.

3 · Every change can be undone. One action restores what was there, and everyone is told again.

E4 Including and excluding people

- People can be **added or removed at any time, by anyone** — before the meeting or after it has been arranged.
- Chosen **by name**, or **by description** — "*the course team*", "*everyone working on the AI Tools course*". The assistant resolves the description to actual people and shows who it picked before anything is sent.
- **While you are choosing, it shows what each person already has** at that time — so a clash is visible before the invitation goes out, not after.
- **Removing someone tells them**, and says who removed them. Being dropped from a meeting silently is the single worst thing an open calendar can do.

✦ Adding the course team — that is Priya, Arun and Karthik. Karthik already has something at 11.

E5 When something changes

- The calendar updates **immediately** for everyone.
- Everyone in the meeting or event is told, in the form they normally receive things — a line in the brief, or a notification if it is imminent.
- The message always names **what changed and who changed it**, never just "*this meeting was updated*".
- **Undo is offered to anyone who was affected**, not only to whoever made the change.
- If the change lands on work somebody had committed to, the rules in **A6** apply — the work reschedules itself and is marked interrupted.

✦ Arun moved Thursday's review from 11:00 to 15:00 and added Meena. [OK] [Undo]

E6 By conversation as well

Everything above works through the assistant, not only on the screen:

"Move tomorrow's review to 3 and add Meena"
"Who is coming to Thursday's event?"
"Cancel Friday's catch-up and tell everyone"
"What is already booked the week of the 15th?"

E7 In person, online, or both

Every meeting is one of three kinds, chosen when it is created.

KIND	WHAT THE APPLICATION DOES
In person	A room is booked through feature 25, checked for capacity and equipment
Online	A meeting link is created automatically and sent to everyone invited
Both	A room and a link — so anyone who cannot come in can still join. This should be the easy default, not an afterthought

The link

- **Created the moment the meeting is created.** Nobody generates a link, copies one, or pastes one in — if the meeting is online, the link exists.
- **Sent to everyone invited**, with the invitation, in one action.
- **It does not change** when the meeting is moved, renamed or edited. A link that changes every time somebody adjusts the time is worse than no link at all.
- Visible in three places: on the **calendar entry**, in the **invitation**, and on each person's **day** — so nobody has to go hunting five minutes before it starts.
- ★ **Anyone added later is sent the link automatically.** Adding a person to an online meeting without giving them the link is the most common way this goes wrong.
- Cancelling the meeting **ends the link**.

People outside the organization

- External attendees are invited **by email address** and receive the link and the details the same way anyone else does.
- They need **no account** and see nothing else in the application.
- They appear on the meeting as external, so it is always clear who is not staff.

Provider not yet chosen. The behaviour above is specified regardless of who supplies the video service. **Google Meet is the likely candidate** and the user's stated expectation, but it sits with the wider provider decision, which is still open. Nothing in this section depends on which is chosen.